

Viewshed analysis

What this tool produces · *Computational 3D maps and cumulative visual profiles demonstrating exactly which parts of a historic landscape will remain visible, or become blocked, by a new development.*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Dimensions

Spatial

Heritage

Preparing the workshop · *Viewshed analysis*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Why this tool matters

Defending the right to look at the sky and the history of the city; ensuring that the visual poetry of a historic skyline is not stolen by thoughtless real estate speculation.

Evidence we produce

Computational 3D maps and cumulative visual profiles demonstrating exactly which parts of a historic landscape will remain visible, or become blocked, by a new development.

Duration & Material

Duration · 2 to 4 weeks of digital modeling and spatial analysis

Material · GIS software (CityEngine, QGIS), 3D city models, architectural massing proposals

Reference case

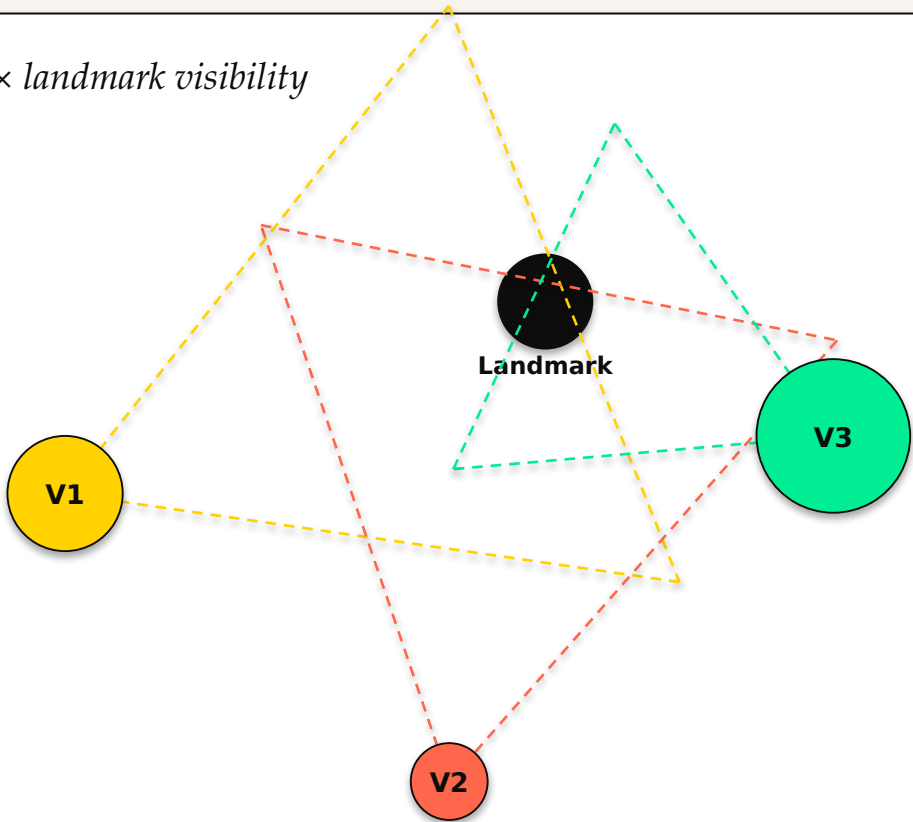
The Visual Impact Size (VIS) method utilizes cumulative viewsheds to simulate the impact of tall buildings on historical dominants. By comparing the viewshed analyses of protected historical buildings against planned modern facilities, planners can identify exactly which exposure locations are threatened, showing the actual visual impact on the cityscape before planning permission is granted.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Sight cones · what is seen from where

Duration
2 to 4 weeks of digital modeling and spatial analysis

Viewpoint × landmark visibility



Viewpoint inventory

Viewpoint	Visible?	Quality

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.